

Tall Tales/ Fables





About the Course

Along with fairy tales from around the world, this course introduces students to Aesop's famous fables and classic American or Canadian tall tales.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 1



Placement & Combining Tips

Easily combined with hungry Kindergarteners or Grade 2 students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1	Tall Tales/ Fables 1 time/week 15 min	Aesop's Favorite Fables American Tall Tales The Spirit of Canada: Canada's Story in Legends, Fiction, Poems, and Songs

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 1				
		Fairy Tales	Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12	Tall Tales/ Fables



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Literature: Grade 1

☐ As desired, plan for a read-aloud time together. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Tall Tales/ Fables



Aesop's Favorite Fables



American Tall Tales



The Spirit of Canada: Canada's Story in Legends, Fiction, Poems, and Songs



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



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How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something that the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Optional: use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

SAMPLE

Tall Tales/ Fables

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 1

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Davy Crockett

PREP: Read "Introduction" p.x-xii and "Notes on the Story" p.3.

→ INTRO

These are exaggerated tales of true and imaginary American heroes.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.5-9 "An extraordinary event" - "learn some manners."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

PREP: Read "Tall Tales" p.158.

→ INTRO

We'll be reading various tales from Canada this year! Read the short introduction before each tale and then the story itself.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.3-4 "How Two-Feather Was Saved from Loneliness"

★ TEACHER NOTE

The Spirit of Canada includes many different stories, songs, tales, and historical accounts significant to Canadian history. Although students read selected tales in this course, other selections from the book are used in the history courses as well.

WEEK 2 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 2

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Davy Crockett

→ INTRO

Locate Davy Crockett on the map at the front of the book. Did he live near your home?

Map Resource: American Tall Tales "United States Map"

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.10-13 "So Davy Crockett" - "much better myself."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.5-6 "Manabozho and the Maple Trees"

★ TEACHER TIP

If you haven't planned for a Community Read Aloud yet, consider adding it to your gathering or mealtime, or as a way to lighten the burden of chores! You can find suggestions in Quick Links.

WEEK 3 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 3

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Davy Crockett

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13 "In spite of" - "in his pocket."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-8 "How the Thunder Made Horses"

● ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.